bass adds depth and weight to the track, giving it a fuller, more immersive feel. The same goes for Ramta Jogi from Taal, where the driving rhythm and punchy percussion benefit from the extra emphasis on lower frequencies.

What surprised me, though, is that the vocals and guitars don't get buried. The mids hold their ground, and there's a nice lift in the upper mids that keeps voices present. On an acoustic track like Ed Sheeran's Thinking Out Loud, the guitar and vocals still sound natural, even while the bass does most of the heavy lifting. For everyday listening, whether I'm commuting or working, it's an easy sound to enjoy, especially if I like my music with some body to it.

Our testing confirms the same overall sound signature. The frequency response graph shows a gradual decline through much of the midrange, followed by a rise in the upper mids and lower treble before the response rolls off towards the highest frequencies.

One thing I liked most about the Live Beam 4 is how much control JBL gives you. The app has a 10-band equaliser, so instead of being limited to a few preset sounds, I could shape the sound band by band, adding a little treble here or easing up on the mids there.

EQ and personalisation are subjective and ultimately come down to personal preference. If you find the buds too bass-heavy or prefer brighter vocals, I'd suggest trying a more balanced profile, such as Jazz. Personally, though, I prefer my bass with a little extra punch. While the default sound profile is decent, tracks from the golden era of Punjabi pop, such as Mundian To Bach Ke by Panjabi MC, sound more exciting to me with the bass turned up, as sometimes I just want that extra thump.

ANC AND AMBIENT MODES

The Live Beam 4's Active Noise Cancellation (ANC) is effective enough to soften everyday indoor sounds, such as air conditioners, keyboard typing and nearby conversations, helping me focus without increasing the volume. However, louder traffic and voices remain noticeable outdoors, so the ANC isn't ideal for those expecting exceptional noise isolation. Enabling the feature also reduces the claimed battery life of the earbuds significantly.





While testing the ambient modes on the device, I found that Ambient Aware was less natural when compared to the TalkThru mode, which worked much better, allowing me to converse without removing the earbuds.

VERDICT

The JBL Live Beam 4 gets several things right. I like its energetic, bass-forward sound, extensive EQ options, touchscreen case, wireless charging, and long battery life. The ability to personalise the listening experience is a genuine advantage, and the earbuds offer enough features to satisfy someone who enjoys having control over their audio. I would consider the Live Beam 4 if I wanted feature-rich earbuds with an engaging sound and plenty of customisation. But I would make sure the fit worked for me before committing to them, especially if I planned to use them while travelling or exercising.

– Bhaskar Sharma

SPECIFICATIONS

Drivers: 10 mm Dynamic Driver | Microphones: 6-mic system | Audio features: JBL signature sound, Hi-Res Audio wireless, JBL Spatial sound | Noise Cancellation: Adaptive NC 2.0 with Real-time calibration | Battery: Upto 48 hours | Charging: Type C and Qi Wireless charging | Connectivity: Bluetooth with LE audio, multi point, Google Audio Switch | IP rating: IP55 |Charging Case: Interactive display with volume, track, ANC controls

CONTACT

JBL India | Email ID: Web Form | Number: 1800-102-0525 | Website: https://in.jbl.com/

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